

TASK 3: NOW THAT WE'VE SEEN A VARIETY OF PERSPECTIVES ON INTERRUPTING AND BEING INTERRUPTED, TRY THIS GOAL SETTING ACTIVITY:

A. The next time you want to interrupt someone, instead of making your point, try paraphrasing their words and ideas.

Then ask them if your interpretation of their viewpoint is correct. Note whether your original intent for interrupting has changed or still holds true.

B. The next time you're interrupted, instead of using one of the phrases we've covered in this lesson to maintain your own momentum, ask you conversation partner(s) to paraphrase your idea or argument.

This may take some courage! Nevertheless, it will confirm they are indeed listening and may lessen the impact of their interruption by maintaining continuity and agreement. How will this tactic affect (hopefully enhance!) your work relationships?

Note your thoughts down in your journal.